

Module 1: Orientation & Quick Start

This module fast-tracks your transition into the mortgage field services industry. You are not just taking pictures; you are becoming a specialized documentarian providing empirical data for a multi-billion dollar risk management industry.

Lesson 1: Field Services as a High-Velocity Income Stream

Core Concept: Shift from low-paying gig work (\$5–10 per delivery) or time-intensive professional roles to high-volume, 10-minute property inspections paying \$50–\$150 each.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Register as an Independent Contractor:** Apply to a vetted firm like National Field Representatives (NFR) or National Risk Services (NRS).
2. **Clear the Background Check:** Obtain an ABC# through Shield Hub (approx. \$50) to verify your eligibility for lender work.
3. **Setup Your Mobile Office:** Ensure you have a fuel-efficient vehicle, a smartphone with a high-resolution camera, and high-speed internet.
4. **Accept Your Territory:** Once onboarded, you will be assigned a specific geographic batch of orders.

Audience-Specific Examples:

- **Gig Workers:** Use your existing routing skills to hit 4–8 stops per hour, turning a \$15/hr driving job into a \$30–\$60/hr professional service.
- **Notaries:** Apply your "verify and witness" habits to property occupancy and condition instead of loan signatures.

Quick Win: Complete your first "Drive-By" occupancy check—typically a 5-minute exterior observation. **Warning Signs:** Treating this as "casual" work. Lenders require professional-grade reliability and strict adherence to due dates.

Lesson 2: Mastering Basic Industry Terminology

Core Concept: Professional proficiency begins with a command of the technical lexicon used by lenders and investors.

Key Terms:

- **PCR (Property Condition Report):** The standard data deliverable documenting the state of the asset.
- **SLA (Service Level Agreement):** The contractual deadline for your report (typically 3–5 days).
- **REO (Real Estate Owned):** Properties the bank has already foreclosed on; these require regular "REO Checks" for maintenance.
- **Loss Draft:** Inspections that verify the progress of repairs after an insurance claim (e.g., fire or storm damage).

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Download the Base Standard PCR:** Familiarize yourself with the NAMFS standard fields.
2. **Monitor Your Queue:** Check your app (InspectorADE or Focus) daily for new orders and their respective SLAs.

Quick Win: Use the term "SLA" when communicating with your account manager to demonstrate industry readiness. **Warning Signs:** Missing an SLA. Reports not received within 20 days may be reissued, and your payment forfeited.

Lesson 3: Scope of Practice—Field Inspector vs. Home Inspector

Core Concept: You are a non-invasive observer documenting facts, not a licensed professional diagnosing structural failures.

Feature	Field Inspector (You)	Home Inspector (Not You)
Goal	Risk mitigation and collateral preservation	Diagnostic assessment for buyers
Method	Ground-level, visual observation only	Invasive testing of HVAC/Electrical
Action	Document the ceiling stain	Diagnose the roof leak
Cost	High volume, low per-unit fee (\$50-\$150)	Low volume, high professional fee (\$300+)

Audience-Specific Examples:

- **Realtors:** Avoid the urge to estimate repair costs. Simply document the damage to avoid liability and conflict of interest.

Quick Win: Practice describing a cracked window as "one cracked pane on front window" rather than "window needs replacement". **Warning Signs:** Climbing on a roof or opening a breaker panel. These are invasive actions outside your scope.

Lesson 4: The 6-Angle Rule and Technical Photography

Core Concept: Photographs are the primary unit of value; a report without forensic-quality photos is considered fraudulent.

The 6-Angle Sequence:

1. **Street Sign:** Proves you are in the correct neighborhood.
2. **House Number:** Direct verification of the collateral address.
3. **Front Elevation:** Straight-on shot including the entire roofline.
4. **Front Left Angle:** Perspective showing the front and left side.
5. **Front Right Angle:** Perspective showing the front and right side.
6. **Street Views (Left & Right):** Documents the neighborhood context.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Disable Orientation Lock:** All photos must be taken in **landscape mode**.
2. **Exit the Vehicle:** Never take photos through a windshield. Car parts (mirrors/dashboards) in a shot trigger immediate rejection.
3. **Sync Metadata:** Ensure your app is embedding GPS, date/time stamps, and your Inspector ID.

Quick Win: Capture the "Front Elevation" with 5% open space on all sides to provide full context. **Warning Signs:** Blurry images, fingers in the frame, or shadows of the inspector.

Lesson 5: The Workflow—From Work Order to Payment

Core Concept: Success is found in efficient routing and the "First-Time Pass" rate of your reports.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. **Sync (Daily):** Hit "Download" in your app to pull new orders and check for cancellations.
2. **Route (The Night Before):** Use GPS software to group 4–8 stops per hour.
3. **Execute & Upload (On-Site):** Complete the digital checklist and upload photos **before** leaving the property to avoid return trips.
4. **Payday:** Payments are typically processed bi-weekly (every other Friday) via direct deposit.

Quick Win: Install a non-contact volt stick (approx. \$10) to quickly verify power at vacant properties without touching wires. **Warning Signs:** Submitting "Unknown" for occupancy. This is considered "a hamburger without the meat" and is useless to the lender.

Lesson 6: Avoiding Beginner Mistakes by Audience Type

Core Concept: Every professional background has a "Subjectivity Trap" that leads to rejected reports.

Audience-Specific Hazards:

- **Realtors (The Professional Conclusion):** Mistake: Reporting a roof "needs replacement." Correct: Document "missing shingles on south-facing slope".
- **Notaries (The "No Answer" Default):** Mistake: Marking a property "Unknown" if no one answers the door. Correct: Check utility meters and signs of life (trash cans, mail, pets).
- **Gig Workers (The Drive-By Habit):** Mistake: Taking photos from the driver's seat. Correct: You **must** exit the vehicle to prove a full visual survey.
- **Existing Inspectors (Subjective Prose):** Mistake: Reporting "Occupant was rude." Correct: "Occupant stated [quote] and slammed the door".

Quick Win: Always include a photo of a lit doorbell or a spinning electric meter as definitive proof of occupancy. **Warning Signs:** Using adjectives like "overwhelmingly," "terrible," or "aggressive." Stick to objective, factual descriptions.